COLLIN NICHOLAS

Director of Product at Persado

Annandale, VA | Collin.R.Nicholas@gmail.com
collinnicholas.com | linkedin.com/in/collinnicholas

Product leader building AI products and the systems that demonstrate their commercial value. Leads growth and retention product at Persado, connecting agentic acquisition workflows, experiment-driven customer ROI and product design. Background spans enterprise SaaS, platform integrations, responsible AI and hands-on product development.

Focus: AI product strategy | Growth and retention | Agentic workflows | Customer value realization
Roadmaps and monetization | Product design | Enterprise platforms | Responsible AI | AI-assisted engineering

EXPERIENCE

Persado

Director of Product Aug 2026 - Present

- Own the growth and retention product portfolio for enterprise financial services; lead the product design function.
- Lead Market Scan, an AI asset-intelligence product that audits live and planned marketing content for conversion performance and regulatory compliance, then prioritizes optimization opportunities.
- Designed and built an agentic prospecting engine on Market Scan to identify ICP accounts, benchmark marketing assets and generate evidence-backed outreach; rolling out across the U.S. banking market.
- Own the ROI & Value Dashboard, turning real experiment outcomes into dollar-denominated customer value delivered monthly and used in Customer Success QBRs and renewal motions.

Employ Inc.

Senior Product Manager Jul 2025 - Aug 2026

- Shipped a five-feature AI screening suite that generated $30K ARR and reached 14 enterprise customers within three months of launch.
- Launched the company's first AI trust and integrity initiative with a vibe-coded MVP, generating 300+ registrations and 20-40 inbound demo requests at launch.
- Independently authored, tested and merged 16 production pull requests into the Lever ATS and Pillar AI Interview Intelligence codebases.
- Revamped AI matching with human-in-the-loop prompting, custom matching logic and a transparency layer; deployed as a revenue-generating job add-on across 23,000 SMB customers.
- Built and launched the in-app AI Marketplace with GTM and Revenue teams, supporting internal enablement and customer awareness.
- Led IBM WatsonX.Gov responsible AI governance, including bias detection, accuracy oversight and enterprise AI security inquiries.
- Saved a $330K multi-year enterprise renewal over six-plus months following a complex post-acquisition integration failure.

EXPERIENCE CONTINUED

Jobvite

Product Manager Mar 2021 - Jul 2025

- Owned Candidate Texting across 2,300+ organizations and 18,000 users; drove 36% YoY growth in customer activity and 10% YoY SMS volume growth.
- Led a nine-month NextGen UI transformation across 1,500 enterprise customers, including a three-wave rollout, cross-functional leadership alignment and an Early Adopter program.
- Architected the first cross-product shared service across three ATS platforms with VONQ and LinkedIn, generating $1.76M ARR in its first year.
- Led AI solution direction, Talent Fit rollout and vendor evaluation across Jobvite, Lever and JazzHR; partnered on AI voice/chat screening with structured dossier handoff into the ATS.

MicroStrategy

Progressive product and technical roles Mar 2015 - Mar 2021

Product Owner, HyperIntelligence Mobile May 2020 - Mar 2021

- Owned the iOS/iPad product roadmap and backlog; partnered with product, sales and IT to incorporate market-driven features.

Principal Consultant Jan 2020 - May 2020

- Led enterprise advisory and production implementation work, resolving complex platform issues and identifying follow-on opportunities.

Principal Technical Program Manager Jan 2018 - Jan 2020

- Generated $31M in pipeline in 18 months; scaled the program to 400+ customers and grew and managed a team of six.
- Developed global methodology and training delivered to 500+ consultants, and strategic roadmaps for C-level audiences.

Manager, Technical Support | Feb 2017 - Dec 2017

Advanced Product Support | Jul 2016 - Feb 2017

Technical Support Engineer | Mar 2015 - Jul 2016

FICO

Product Support Engineer Jul 2012 - Mar 2015

- Supported customers through server migrations, recovery, quality assurance and technical documentation.

SELECTED INDEPENDENT PROJECTS

The PM Toolkit - Product discovery, cited research and connected planning artifacts.

BidPacket - Construction bid prep: summaries, materials checklists and proposal drafts.

Arclo Pro - Websites and ongoing SEO for local businesses, with search-performance reporting.

Loupe *(in development)* - Browser session capture, UX review and implementation briefs for AI coding agents.

EDUCATION

Central Connecticut State University | Aug 2007 - Dec 2010

Bachelor of Science - Mechanical Engineering / Mechanical Technology